Guojiao Zhao (Zoe)

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EDUCATION

Shanghai Jiao Tong University *Sept. 2023 – Aug 2027*

- B.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering, minor in Computer Science, Data Science. GPA: 3.76/4.0
- *Coursework:* Data Structures and Algorithms, Computer Vision, Intro to Signals and Systems, Probabilistic Methods in Eng., Design of Microprocessor Based Systems, etc.

Cornell University *Jan. 2026 - May 2026*

- Exchange Program, GPA:3.89/4.0
- *Coursework:* AI Reasoning/Decision-Making, Intro to Machine Learning, Intro to Deep Learning, Optimization for AI.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Efficient and Precise Black-Box LLM Jailbreaking *Project Leader* *Jun. 2025 – Dec. 2025*

Advisor: Prof. David Woodruff | Carnegie Mellon University

- Proposed Semantic Steer Chain (SSC), a black-box LLM red-teaming framework based on progressive semantic approximation, and led the overall SSC design and implementation.
- Designed and conducted experiments on JailbreakBench dataset across 18 safety-aligned LLMs, achieving an 85.7% average attack success rate (ASR) and a 20+ percentage-point improvement over adaptive baselines.

Emotional Recognition based on Deep Learning *Research Assistant* *Jul. 2024 – Oct. 2025*

Advisor: Prof. Ruigang Yang | Shanghai Jiao Tong University

- Designed Morphological Convolutional Channel Local Attention module (MCCLA), a lightweight morphology-aware attention module to preserve subtle facial-expression cues and enhance local structural continuity.
- Improved RAF-DB accuracy from 90.68% to 91.23% with only 0.01M additional parameters.

LLM-based Optimization Method *Research Assistant* *Feb. 2026 – Now*

Advisor: Prof. Ruihao Zhu | Cornell University

- Proposed a Semantic Obligation Hypergraph representation that maps natural-language optimization problems into canonical decision entities and constraint relationships, independent of solver-specific formulations.
- Built an LLM-based annotation and evaluation pipeline and conducted controlled constraint-augmentation experiments to study how semantic complexity affects automated optimization modeling accuracy.

PUBLICATION

Semantic Steer Chain: Efficient and Precise Black-Box Jailbreaking through Adaptive Approximation. The 30th Pacific-Asia Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (PAKDD). Hongkong, Jun. 2026. (Co-first author & Corresponding author)

LLMamba-Net: A Lightweight Network Integrating Linear Mamba for Facial Expression Recognition. The 8th Chinese Conference on Pattern Recognition and Computer Vision (PRCV). Shanghai, Oct. 2025.

AWARDS

- 2009 SEIEE Alumni Scholarship, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, 2024 (Top 20%)
- The Sam and Daisy Wu Scholarship, Global College, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, 2025 (Top 10%)
- Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling, Honorable Mention, 2025 (Top 20%)

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)
- **Technical Skills:** Python, C++, C, MATLAB, SQL